



Photograph Sonu Sharma

Each month, *Digit* will carry a caption for a photo. Come up with something funnier, and beat the *Digit* team at their own game! Entries accepted by the 15th of this month.

Beat That!

Digit Caption
"E-Tea!"

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Bhaves N Momaya
Chalisgaon, Dist. Jalgaon
"The Window-modded PC cabinet"



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SCJP Sun Certified Programmer for Java 5

by Kathy Sierra & Bert Bates

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could integrate with Creative's digital media players. Creative alleges that after the agreement, executives from the two companies—including Apple CEO Steve Jobs—had discussions to "explore ways in which the companies could work together. Creative showed Apple several prototype portable digital media players that showed the patented interface"—meaning that Apple just stole the idea.

Creative asked for no less than the US International Trade Commission to bar Apple from importing iPods, iPod nanos, and iPod Minis from its manufacturing operations in China. The company is also asking for monetary damages amounting to triple what the court might find as the damage that Creative has suffered as a result of the patent impingement. (As of April 1, 2006, Apple had sold 50 million iPods.)

Apple reacted by counter-suing Creative in a Wisconsin District Court, alleging that Creative infringes four patents it

holds for digital music players. Apparently, two can play at this game!

But it was Creative who started it, and was that a case of a company patenting something rather general only to sue later? Think about it: it's an *interface* we're talking about. There's nothing special about it: it's a simple, intuitive way to navigate through data. How would Apple let users sort through their MP3s without using the kind of menu it does? And the question everyone is asking is, what took Creative so long to complain?

NET PORN COMPANIES HAPPY

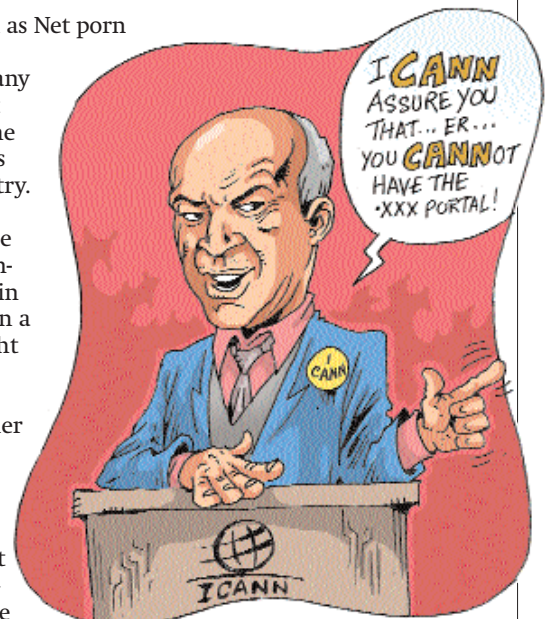
ICANN: No .XXX

ICANN, the body that oversees how Internet names are awarded, has once and for all turned down the proposal to create the .xxx domain for porn sites. The proposal has existed for a long time, and has faced opposition from conservative

groups as well as Net porn companies.

The company that was most pushing for the .xxx domain is the ICM Registry. According to ICM—and some people—a porn-specific domain would result in a virtual red-light area, clearly identifiable, making it easier to prevent children from accessing porn. On the surface of it, it sounds good—there would be no need for porn filters: just block .xxx URLs! But actually, it's much more complicated.

Mukul Krishna, an analyst with Frost & Sullivan, said the porn industry doesn't want a special domain, and that governments don't want it either. "ICANN doesn't want it because it doesn't have the resources," he said, adding that the issue would



probably fade into the background.

ICANN initially decided in favour of adding .xxx to the list of top level domains in June of 2005, but pressure from conservatives and the Bush government led to ICANN revoking its decision. The US Government argues that the creation of a specific porn domain would allow for more porn on the Net.